



FREE SAMPLE LESSON PLAN

Ancient Civilizations

Reading Comprehension — The Lost Civilization of the Aztecs

Level	3AS — Troisième Année Secondaire
Textbook	New Prospects, Unit 1
Sequence	Sequence 1 — Reading & Writing
Duration	60 minutes
Class size	32 pupils, mixed ability
Framework	APC-aligned · Bloom's Taxonomy · SMART objectives

Lesson Plan

Field	Value
Level	3AS (Année Secondaire)
Stream	Literary & Philosophy / Foreign Languages (adaptable)
Textbook	New Prospects
Unit / Sequence	Unit 1 — Ancient Civilizations / Sequence 1: Reading & Writing
Lesson title	Reading Comprehension — The Lost Civilization of the Aztecs
Time allotted	60 minutes
Class size	32 pupils, mixed ability
Date	—

Target Competency / Final Objective

By the end of the lesson, learners will be able to **interpret a historical text about an ancient civilization, identify its key features (location, achievements, decline) and produce a short written reaction justifying their personal opinion.**

Can-do statement: "I can read a historical text, locate specific information, infer meaning from context, and write a short response that supports my opinion with evidence from the text."

Learning Objectives (SMART + Bloom's Taxonomy)

By the end of the lesson, learners will be able to:

1. **(Remember)** Identify at least 5 factual details about the Aztec civilization from the text.
2. **(Understand)** Interpret 4 contextual vocabulary items related to civilization and history.
3. **(Apply)** Use scanning & skimming strategies to answer comprehension questions in < 10 minutes.
4. **(Analyze)** Distinguish facts from inferences in a historical text.
5. **(Evaluate / Create)** Produce a 4–5-sentence written reaction justifying a personal opinion with textual evidence.

Cross-curricular & Transversal Competencies

- **Intellectual:** critical thinking, inference, comparison
 - **Methodological:** reading strategies (skimming, scanning, intensive reading), note-taking
 - **Communicative:** expressing opinions in writing, justifying ideas with evidence
 - **Personal & social:** respect for cultural heritage, awareness of historical diversity
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Core Values

- **National identity & openness to the world:** appreciating both Algerian and global cultural heritage.
 - **Citizenship:** valuing the contribution of past civilizations to the modern world.
 - **Critical-mindedness:** distinguishing established facts from interpretations.
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Materials & Teaching Aids

- New Prospects textbook, page 14–15 (essential)
 - Whiteboard / chalkboard + markers (essential)
 - Printed handout: text + tasks (essential, 1 per pupil or 1 per pair)
 - Map of the Americas (optional — can be sketched on the board)
 - Timer / clock (essential for stage timing)
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Anticipated Difficulties

Difficulty	Mitigation
Unfamiliar lexis (civilization, empire, decline, conquer, ruins)	Pre-teach via images, definitions, antonyms; provide a mini glossary on the handout.
Confusion between Aztec / Maya / Inca	Brief board map locating the Aztec empire (Mexico).
Difficulty justifying opinions in writing	Provide sentence starters: "In my opinion... because the text says..."
Mixed ability — weaker readers may finish late	Tiered handout with starred (*) optional questions for fast finishers.

Previous Knowledge

Learners are assumed to: - Know basic past simple tense (covered in 2AS) - Be familiar with the concept of "civilization" from 4AM social studies - Be able to scan a text for specific information

Lesson Stages

Stage	Time	Teacher's Activity	Pupils' Activity	Interaction	Aim
Warm-up	5'	Greets pupils. Shows the eliciting question on the board: "Which ancient civilizations have you heard about?" Writes 3–4 names elicited on the board.	Brainstorm orally; recall names: Egyptians, Greeks, Romans, Carthaginians, Aztecs...	T ↔ Ps	Activate schema; engage learners; introduce the topic.
Lead-in	5'	Shows / sketches a map of the Americas. Asks: "Where would you place the Aztec civilization?" Pre-teaches 4 key items: civilization, empire, ruins, decline (using definition + visuals + example sentences). Concept-checks: "Is a civilization a small village? → No. Are ruins old or new? → Old."	Locate Mexico on the map; repeat new lexis chorally then individually; answer CCQs.	T ↔ Ps	Pre-teach essential lexis; lower the affective filter before reading.
While-reading 1 (skim for gist)	8'	Distributes the text. Sets the task: "Read quickly — you have 3 minutes. Answer: What is the text mainly about?" Sets ICQs: "Are we reading every word? Do we have a lot of time?"	Skim the text individually; choose between three options on the board (a/b/c); compare with a partner.	Individual → P ↔ P	Develop skimming sub-skill; check global understanding.
While-reading 2 (scan for specific info)	12'	Sets 5 comprehension questions: 1) Where did the Aztecs live? 2) When was their empire at its peak? 3) Name 2 achievements. 4) Who conquered them? 5) Find a synonym for "fall".	Scan the text, write short answers in pairs, justify with line references.	P ↔ P	Develop scanning sub-skill; train evidence-based reading.

Stage	Time	Teacher's Activity	Pupils' Activity	Interaction	Aim
Practice (intensive / inference)	10'	Sets 2 inference tasks: T/F + justify ("The Aztecs had a writing system" / "The conquest was peaceful"); 1 inference: "Why does the writer use the word 'tragic' in line 18?" Monitors and supports weaker pairs.	Reread the relevant paragraphs; discuss in pairs; justify orally.	P ↔ P	Move from lower-order to higher-order thinking (Bloom: Analyze).
Production (written reaction)	15'	Sets the task: "In 4–5 sentences, write your reaction: What lesson can today's world learn from the fall of the Aztec empire?" Provides sentence starters on the board (In my opinion... / The text shows that... / I think this is important because...). Circulates and supports.	Plan ideas individually (2'); draft (10'); peer-edit using a 3-point checklist: opinion stated / evidence given / 1 connector used (3').	Individual + P ↔ P	Develop written production; integrate text content with personal opinion (Bloom: Evaluate / Create).
Wrap-up	5'	Invites 2–3 volunteers to read aloud. Gives quick oral feedback. Recaps key vocabulary. Sets homework.	Volunteers share; class listens; copy homework.	T ↔ Ps	Closure; reinforce learning; check affective state.

Total: 60 minutes.

Expected Pupils' Answers

Skim for gist: (b) The Aztec civilization and its decline.

Scan questions: 1. In central Mexico (around Tenochtitlán). 2. The 14th–16th century. 3. Floating gardens, accurate calendar, advanced agriculture, monumental architecture (any 2). 4. The Spanish conquistadors led by Hernán Cortés. 5. Decline / collapse.

Inference: - T/F: "The Aztecs had a writing system." → **True** ("They used pictographic writing..." line 12). - "The conquest was peaceful." → **False** ("violent invasion" / "tragic end" lines 18–19). - Inference on "tragic": the writer expresses regret over the loss of culture, not just the military defeat.

Written reaction (sample):

In my opinion, the fall of the Aztec empire teaches us that no civilization is permanent. The text shows that even powerful empires can collapse when they meet a stronger force. I think this is important because today's nations should value cultural diversity and protect heritage sites for future generations.

Differentiation Strategies

Tier	Strategy
Struggling learners	Provide a glossary box on the handout; pair with a stronger peer; allow 3 of 5 scan questions; sentence starters mandatory in production.
On-level learners	Standard task; encourage at least 1 connector and 1 piece of textual evidence in production.
Advanced learners	Optional starred questions: "Compare the Aztec civilization with one other ancient civilization you know"; encourage 2 connectors and direct quotation in production.

Assessment

Formative (during the lesson): - Monitoring pair work during scan and inference stages. - Quick oral CCQs after the lead-in. - Peer-editing checklist (opinion / evidence / connector).

Summative (end-of-lesson task — written reaction):

Criterion	0	1	2
Task fulfillment	Off-topic / no opinion	Opinion stated, weak evidence	Clear opinion + textual evidence
Organization	No structure	Some logical order	Clear introduction → reasoning → conclusion
Grammar & vocabulary	Frequent errors block meaning	Errors but meaning clear	Few errors; uses lesson lexis
Mechanics	Many issues	Some issues	Spelling & punctuation accurate

Total: /8 — converted to /20 for reporting.

Homework

Write a paragraph (8–10 sentences) titled **"An Ancient Civilization I Admire."** Pupils choose any civilization (Algerian heritage encouraged: Numidians, Carthaginians, Berbers) and follow the same structure: location → achievements → reason for admiration. To be submitted next session.

Remedial Activities

If > 30% of pupils fail the production task: 1. Re-teach the opinion-justification structure with a guided model on the board. 2. Provide a writing frame: In my opinion, ... because ... For example, the text says ... 3. Re-assess with a shorter prompt (2–3 sentences) the following session. 4. Use bilingual support (Arabic / French) only for clarification of complex inference questions.

Classroom Management Tips

1. **Time discipline.** Use a visible timer for each stage; announce 1-minute warnings before transitions.
 2. **Pair formation.** Pre-arrange mixed-ability pairs (one strong + one developing reader) before the lesson to save time.
 3. **Maximize STT (Student Talking Time).** During pair-check phases, sit at one corner of the room and let pupils self-correct — intervene only after 30 seconds.
 4. **Manage the production stage.** Walk a fixed loop around the room; do not get stuck with one pair. Note 2–3 common errors for delayed correction at the wrap-up.
 5. **Closing energy.** End with a positive recap: “Today you read a real historical text, found specific information, and wrote your own reaction in English — well done.”
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Teacher’s Self-Reflection Prompts

1. Which stage took longer than planned, and why? How will I adjust next time?
 2. Did all three ability tiers produce a written response? If not, which differentiation strategy needs strengthening?
 3. Which question generated the deepest discussion? Can I reuse that question type in the next lesson?
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This is a Fearless Creations free sample. The full library of premium lesson plans for 1AS, 2AS, 3AS and BAC preparation is available at creativekidsdigit.github.io.